



HEART SOFTENERS

F R O M S A H I H M U S L I M

EXPLAINED BY

ASH-SHEIKH ABDUL AZIZ AR-RAJHI



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FORWARD

بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

All praises belong to Allah the Most High and May His peace and blessings shower on the Prophet (ﷺ), his companions and everyone who follows their path until the Day of Judgment. Undoubtedly we are living in some strange and trying times. Since 2020 began there have been rumours of wars, financial crisis, mass unemployment and a pandemic. In times like these, we can get sidetracked and lose sight of our purpose in this world. A solution to alleviate the stress and worries of a bleak future can be found in this book of heart softeners taken from Imam Muslim's collection. Inside of his collection, there are discussions, on how to cope with this world's tests, fear of going hungry, what the Son of Adam takes from this World and how to be patient with a few Possessions in this life. More importantly, the method of how to escape extreme difficulty is demonstrated.

Imam Al-Munthiri's condensed version of Sahih Muslim for this chapter was the primary reference I used along with the explanation of Ash-Shiekh Abdul Aziz Ar-Rajhi (May Allah preserve him.) If you have read and learned from Ash-Shariah Company's print of Heart Softeners taken from Al-Bukhari's collection with commentary from Al-Imam Al-Uthaymeen, then we are quite confident that you will find this an additional treasure to add to your shelves.

I ask Allah the Most High to allow this small effort of mine to help the Muslims in this life and support me entering Jannah in the next life.

Abu Aaliyah Abdullah Ibn Dwight Battle

Doha, Qatar © Ramadan 16th, 1441H

Explanation of Sahih Muslim- The Book of Heart Softeners

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Acknowledgements: Quranic verses by Dr. Muhammad Taqi-ud-Din Al-Hilali, Ph.D. & Dr. Muhammad Muhsin Khan

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Chapter 1



“Most Of The People Of Paradise are Poor, and Most Of The Inhabitants Of The Fire are Women”

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " قُفْتُ عَلَى بَابِ الْجَنَّةِ فَإِذَا غَامَّةٌ مَنْ دَخَلَهَا الْمَسَاكِينُ وَإِذَا أَصْحَابُ الْجَدِّ مَحْبُوسُونَ إِلَّا أَصْحَابَ النَّارِ فَقَدْ أُمِرَ بِهِمْ إِلَى النَّارِ وَقُفْتُ عَلَى بَابِ النَّارِ فَإِذَا غَامَّةٌ مَنْ دَخَلَهَا النِّسَاءُ " .

Allah's Messenger (may peace be upon him) said: I stood at the door of Paradise and I found that the overwhelming majority of those who entered therein was that of poor people and the wealthy people were detained from entering. The denizens of Hell were commanded to get into Hell, and I stood upon the door of the Fire and the majority amongst them who entered was the women.

Explanation

The book of heart softeners is where the author mentions narrations that soften and soothe the heart thus making it submissive towards Allah. Heart softeners encourage a person to do good deeds to draw closer to the Creator. There is a warning in this hadith against disobedience which serves as a reason to enter into the fire; such as being ungrateful for the blessings that one has, frequently swearing, and cursing.

The Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) saw the hellfire and found that many of its inhabitants were women. The reason for that is found in another narration, “You curse frequently and are ungrateful to your husbands.”^[1]

Also, this hadith shows that the Prophet (ﷺ) saw paradise and found that most of its habitats were the poor. Moreover, he (ﷺ) saw there were a group of people who are being held in prison since they have some unfinished business from this world. They had their portion of this world and were among the wealthy and the rich. It's been

said that those people being held in prison were given leadership and authority, so they are imprisoned based on what they had according to the responsibilities they held. Now as for the poor then their backs are light with fewer burdens and for this the reason they enter Jannah.

In another hadith, it says that *"The poor people will enter Paradise before the rich by 500years and half-day."*^[2]

Some of the people of knowledge use this hadith to show that the poor are superior to the rich. What's more, it shows that a poor person who is patient is better than a rich person who is grateful; however, this isn't clear-cut. The wealthy person who is grateful is better and his bounty is more reciprocal than the poor person who is patient, as he is only patient with himself and with his situation.

Furthermore, this hadith shows that the majority of the people in the hellfire will be women and that most of the people entering into paradise will be the poor. Nevertheless, this does not mean that most of the residents in Jannah are the underprivileged, On the contrary, most of the inhabitants in paradise will be women. In paradise, there is the Horal-Ayn along with the women of this world.

In paradise, every male will at least two wives. There are no bachelors in Jannah. This indicates that most of the people in Jannah will be women and similarly most of the inhabitants in hell will be women, and most of those to enter Paradise will be the poor.

Chapter 2



The Women from this World are the Minority in Paradise

قَالَ كَانَ لِمُطَرِّفِ بْنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ امْرَأَتَانِ فَجَاءَ مِنْ عِنْدِ إِحْدَاهُمَا فَقَالَتِ
الْأُخْرَى جِئْتُ مِنْ عِنْدِ فُلَانَةٍ فَقَالَ جِئْتُ مِنْ عِنْدِ عِمْرَانَ بْنِ حُصَيْنٍ فَحَدَّثَنَا
أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " إِنَّ أَقْلَ سَاكِنِي الْجَنَّةِ النِّسَاءُ "

Mutarrif bin Abdullah had two wives and he came from one of their houses and the other one said: "Did you just leave so and so's house. He said I have come from the house Imran bin. Husain and he told us that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: The women are the minority in Paradise.

Explanation

Mutarrif said that due to the stress from his wife's jealousy. He left one of his wife's home and the other one asked him if he had just left the other wife's house. Then he narrated: "I have come from the house Imran b. Husain and told us that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: The women would be the minority in Paradise."

This could imply that the least amount of people from this world to enter Paradise are women.

Chapter 3



Seeking Refuge in Allah from the Changing of Blessing

عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عُمَرَ، قَالَ كَانَ مِنْ دُعَاءِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنْ زَوَالِ نِعْمَتِكَ وَتَحَوُّلِ عَافِيَتِكَ وَفُجَاءَةِ نِقْمَتِكَ وَجَمِيعِ سَخَطِكَ " .

‘Abdullah b. Umar reported that Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ) supplicated in these words:

“O Allah, I seek refuge in You from the withdrawal of Your blessing and the change of Your protection (from me) and from Your sudden wrath (on me), and from everything that leads to Your displeasure .”

Explanation:

Included in this profound narration are four supplications;

The first supplication is seeking refuge in Allah from the removal of the blessings and these blessings include worldly and religious ones.

The second supplication refers to seeking refuge from the removal of good health and comfort to its opposite, which include trials, calamities, punishment, and a difficult life.

The third supplication includes seeking refuge from the sudden wrath of God.

The fourth supplication mentions seeking refuge from everything that makes Him angry.

It would have been better if perhaps the author would have placed this hadith in the chapter of Supplications; however, this narration softens the heart, humbles it, injects obedience in it and makes it aware of Allah.

Chapter 4



The Trial of the Women

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " مَا تَرَكَتُ بَعْدِي فِتْنَةً هِيَ
أَضْرُّ عَلَى الرِّجَالِ مِنَ النِّسَاءِ "

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: I have not left behind me any trial more injurious to men more than that of women.

Explanation

This narration shows the serious trial that men face from women. Allah has made the man's nature to be inclined towards women. This hadith also warns about the reasons of those trials. Surrounded by those trials for a man is him to look at a strange woman, remain in a private setting with her, or to travel with her while she is lawful for him to marry.

What's more, is the woman should avoid causing trials and tribulations for the man. For instance, her unveiling herself and showing her beauty, and sitting in a private setting with a man who isn't her husband and even traveling with him.

Chapter 5



This World is Sweet and Green

النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " إِنَّ الدُّنْيَا حُلُوةٌ خَضِرَةٌ وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ مُسْتَخْلِفُكُمْ فِيهَا فَيَنْظُرُ كَيْفَ تَعْمَلُونَ فَاتَّقُوا الدُّنْيَا وَاتَّقُوا النِّسَاءَ فَإِنَّ أَوَّلَ فِتْنَةٍ بَنَى إِسْرَائِيلَ كَانَتْ فِي النِّسَاءِ "

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: The world is sweet and green (alluring) and Allah gave you authority over it, in order to see how you act. Therefore, avoid the trial of this worldly life and the allurements of women: verily, the first trial for the Children of Isra'il was caused by women.

Explanation

This hadith warns us about the trials of this world and its women.

"The World is sweet and green..." refers to most people running pursuing this world and preferring it to the next life. Fruits are sweet and green and people look for them.

It has been said the other meaning is a metaphor for something green in this world that quickly becomes dry. This is similar to the verse where Allah said: "The example of the life of this world, it is like the water (rain) which We send down from the sky, and the vegetation of the earth mingles with it, and becomes fresh and green. But (later) it becomes dry and broken pieces, which the winds scatter." [Al-Kahf#45]

"Allah gave you as authority over it," This means Allah has placed us as vicegerents in the Earth.

"to see how you act..." Allah has done this to us to show us our actions. Nothing remains unknown to Allah. To see how we act and behave will manifest the good deeds of the believers and bad ones from the disbelievers and the sinners.

"So avoid the trial of this worldly life and the allurements of women.." This instructs us to take precaution against the

trials of this world and its women. Don't be deceived by them. Thus, you start collecting money by lawful and unlawful means. Be aware of this world as it diverts you from the next life. Realize the dangers of the women and don't get trapped by them, and stay clear of everything that leads you to their allurements.

Chapter 6



The True Value of this World

عَنْ جَابِرِ بْنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ (رضي الله عنه) أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مَرَّ بِالسُّوقِ دَاخِلًا مِنْ بَعْضِ الْعَالِيَةِ وَالنَّاسُ كَنَفَتْهُ فَمَرَّ بِجَدْيٍ أَسْكَمِثٍ فَتَنَاوَلَهُ فَأَخَذَ بِأُذُنِهِ ثُمَّ قَالَ " أَتَيْكُمْ يُحِبُّ أَنْ هَذَا لَهُ يَدْرَهُمْ " . فَقَالُوا مَا نُحِبُّ أَنَّهُ لَنَا بِشَيْءٍ وَمَا نَضَعُ بِهِ قَالَ " أَتُحِبُّونَ أَنَّهُ لَكُمْ " . قَالُوا وَاللَّهِ لَوْ كَانَ حَيًّا كَانَ غَيْبًا فِيهِ لِأَنَّهُ أَسْكَمٌ فَكَيْفَ وَهُوَ مَيْتٌ فَقَالَ " فَوَاللَّهِ لِلدُّنْيَا أَهْوَنُ عَلَى اللَّهِ مِنْ هَذَا عَلَيْكُمْ "

Jabir ibn Abdullah reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) happened to walk through the bazaar entering from the side of 'Aliya and the people were around him. There he found a dead lamb with very small ears. He took hold of its ear and said: Who amongst you would like to have this for a dirham? They said: We do not like to have it even for less than that as it is of no use to us. He said: Do you wish to have it (free of any cost)? They said: By Allah, even if it were alive (we would not have liked to possess that), for there is defect in it as its ears are very small; plus it is dead. Thereupon Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: By Allah, this world is more insignificant in the sight of Allah than it (this dead lamb) is in your eye.

Explanation

This hadith shows the insignificant value of this world and that it isn't equivalent to anything compared to what's with Allah. In this hadith, the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) showed his companions something practical so that they could conceptualize the petty value of this world in Allah's Sight.

When the Prophet (ﷺ) passed by this dead lamb he grabbed it by its small ears and asked his companions, "Who among you would like to have this for a dirham?" meaning who would buy this for a dirham while it had small ears and was dead. Consequently, if this dead lamb is worthless according to the people whether dead or alive, then this World has lesser value to Allah than this lamb's value to you. In another hadith highlighting the value of this World

are The Prophet (ﷺ) words, “Were this world worth a wing of a mosquito, He would not have given a drink of water to a disbeliever.”^[3]

Chapter 7



Asking Allah to Make your Provisions Suffice.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - « اللَّهُمَّ
اجْعَلْ رِزْقَ آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ قُوتًا

*Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said:
“O Allah make the provision of Muhammad’s household sufficient.”*

Explanation

“Sufficient...” is that which nourishes and suffices the body. This supplication saves a person from the ills of being rich and poor together. The one who has sufficiency in his food isn’t poor as he has what is enough for him and he isn’t rich, by not having more than he needs.

This hadith shows the advantage of having just what you need by taking from this world what is enough while desiring the next life.

Chapter 8



The Amount of Food in the Prophet's Home

عَنْ عَائِشَةَ قَالَتْ تُوَفِّي رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - وَمَا فِي رَفِّي مِنْ شَيْءٍ يَأْكُلُهُ ذُو كَبِدٍ إِلَّا شَطْرُ شَعِيرٍ فِي رَفٍّ لِي فَأَكَلْتُ مِنْهُ حَتَّى طَالَ عَلَيَّ فَكَلْتُهُ فَقَنِيَ .

Aisha (رضي الله عنه) said: The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) died when there was nothing on my shelf that a living being could eat except a handful of barley. I ate from it for a long time, then I measured it and it ran out.

Explanation

This narration mentions that Aisha (رضي الله عنه) used to eat a handful of barley, which was left by the Prophet (ﷺ). A person doesn't know where Allah sends His blessings. She ate from it for a long time without it running out and it wasn't until she measured it that it ran out. This could be since he left it she trusted in Allah and relied on Him, thus He sent blessings to that food and when she weighed it to see if she had enough to last her the blessings were lifted , and thus it finished quickly.

Chapter 9



What the Son of Adam takes from this World

عَنْ مُطَرِّفٍ عَنْ أَبِيهِ قَالَ أَتَيْتُ النَّبِيَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ وَهُوَ يَقْرَأُ {الْهَآكُمُ التَّكَاثُرُ} قَالَ " يَقُولُ ابْنُ آدَمَ مَالِي مَالِي - قَالَ - وَهَلْ لَكَ يَا ابْنَ آدَمَ مِنْ مَالِكَ إِلَّا مَا أَكَلْتَ فَأَفْنَيْتَ أَوْ لَبَسْتَ فَأَبْلَيْتَ أَوْ تَصَدَّقْتَ فَأَمْضَيْتَ "

Mutarrif narrated from his father: I came to Allah's Prophet (ﷺ) as he was reciting: "The mutual rivalry" (for piling up of worldly things)diverts you. He said: The son of Adam claims: My wealth, my wealth. And he (ﷺ) said: O son of Adam. Do you have anything of your wealth except that which you consume and utilized, or which you wear and then it was worn out, or you gave as charity and sent it forward?

Explanation

This means that the human being has nothing except what he eats and then consumes it, that which he wears from his clothes and he wears them out, or that which he puts forward for his next life and this remains. This includes projects for charity and keeping ties to family relationships, doing good deeds to the parents, along with similar acts of righteousness to their relatives ,and their parents ,and all other acts of piety.

Chapter 10



The Temporal existence of this World

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " وَاللَّهِ مَا الدُّنْيَا فِي الْآخِرَةِ إِلَّا مِثْلُ مَا يَجْعَلُ أَحَدُكُمْ إِضْبَعَهُ هَذِهِ - وَأَشَارَ يَحْيَى بِالسَّبَّابَةِ - فِي الْيَمِّ فَلْيَنْظُرْ بِمَ يَرْجِعُ "

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: By Allah, this world (is so insignificant in comparison) to the Hereafter that if one of you should dip his finger- (and while saying this Yahya pointed with his forefinger) -in the ocean and then he should see as to what has stuck to it.

Explanation

This hadith sheds light on the relationship of this world in comparison to its lifespan, temporal existence and how it quickly perishes like sticking a finger in an ocean then removing it. How much water remains on the finger?! There is absolutely no comparison of this world to the next.

The Prophet (ﷺ) said: "If the world to Allah was equal to a mosquito's wing, then He would not allow the disbeliever to sip water from it."^[4]

And in another report "We were with the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) in Dhul-Hulaifah when we saw a dead sheep lifting its leg (because of bloating). He said: 'Don't you think this is worthless to its owner? By the One in Whose hand is my soul, this world is more worthless to Allah than this (dead sheep) is to its owner. If this world was worth the wing of a mosquito to Allah, then the disbeliever would not have a drop of water to drink from it.'"^[5]

Chapter 11

How to cope with the tests of this World

أَنَّ أَبَا هُرَيْرَةَ، حَدَّثَهُ أَنَّهُ، سَمِعَ النَّبِيَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ " إِنَّ ثَلَاثَةً فِي بَنِي إِسْرَائِيلَ أَبْرَصَ وَأَقْرَعَ وَأَعْمَى فَأَرَادَ اللَّهُ أَنْ يَبْتَلِيَهُمْ فَبَعَثَ إِلَيْهِمْ مَلَكًا فَآتَى الْأَبْرَصَ فَقَالَ أَيُّ شَيْءٍ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْكَ قَالَ لَوْنٌ حَسَنٌ وَجِلْدٌ حَسَنٌ وَيَذْهَبُ عَنِّي الَّذِي قَدْ قَذَرَنِي النَّاسُ . قَالَ فَمَسَحَهُ فَذَهَبَ عَنْهُ قَذَرُهُ وَأَعْطِي لَوْنًا حَسَنًا وَجِلْدًا حَسَنًا قَالَ فَأَيُّ الْمَالِ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْكَ قَالَ الْإِبِلُ - أَوْ قَالَ الْبَقَرُ شَكَّ إِسْحَاقُ - إِلَّا أَنَّ الْأَبْرَصَ أَوْ الْأَقْرَعَ قَالَ أَحَدُهُمَا الْإِبِلُ وَقَالَ الْآخَرُ الْبَقَرُ - قَالَ فَأَعْطِي نَاقَةً عُشْرَاءَ فَقَالَ بَارَكَ اللَّهُ لَكَ فِيهَا - قَالَ - فَآتَى الْأَقْرَعَ فَقَالَ أَيُّ شَيْءٍ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْكَ قَالَ شَعْرٌ حَسَنٌ وَيَذْهَبُ عَنِّي هَذَا الَّذِي قَذَرَنِي النَّاسُ . قَالَ فَمَسَحَهُ فَذَهَبَ عَنْهُ وَأَعْطِي شَعْرًا حَسَنًا - قَالَ - فَأَيُّ الْمَالِ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْكَ قَالَ الْبَقَرُ . فَأَعْطِي بَقْرَةً حَامِلًا فَقَالَ بَارَكَ اللَّهُ لَكَ فِيهَا - قَالَ - فَآتَى الْأَعْمَى فَقَالَ أَيُّ شَيْءٍ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْكَ قَالَ أَنْ يَرُدَّ اللَّهُ إِلَيَّ بَصَرِي فَأُبْصِرَ بِهِ النَّاسُ - قَالَ - فَمَسَحَهُ فَرَدَّ اللَّهُ إِلَيْهِ بَصَرَهُ . قَالَ فَأَيُّ الْمَالِ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْكَ قَالَ الْغَنَمُ . فَأَعْطِي شَاةً وَالِدًا فَأَنْتِجَ هَذَانِ وَوَلَدَ هَذَا - قَالَ - فَكَانَ لِهَذَا وَادٍ مِنَ الْإِبِلِ وَلِهَذَا وَادٍ مِنَ الْبَقَرِ وَلِهَذَا وَادٍ مِنَ الْغَنَمِ . قَالَ ثُمَّ إِنَّهُ أَتَى الْأَبْرَصَ فِي صُورَتِهِ وَهَيْئَتِهِ فَقَالَ رَجُلٌ مِسْكِينٌ قَدْ انْقَطَعَتْ بِي الْحِبَالُ فِي سَفَرِي فَلَا بَلَاغَ لِي الْيَوْمَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ ثُمَّ بَكَ أَسْأَلُكَ بِالَّذِي أَعْطَاكَ اللَّوْنَ الْحَسَنَ وَالْجِلْدَ الْحَسَنَ وَالْمَالَ بَعِيرًا أَتَبَلَّغَ عَلَيْهِ فِي سَفَرِي . فَقَالَ الْحَقُوقُ كَثِيرَةٌ . فَقَالَ لَهُ كَأَنِّي أَعْرِفُكَ أَلَمْ تَكُنْ أَبْرَصَ يَفْذُرُكَ النَّاسُ فَقِيرًا فَأَعْطَاكَ اللَّهُ فَقَالَ إِنَّمَا وَرِثْتُ هَذَا الْمَالَ كَابِرًا عَنْ كَابِرٍ . فَقَالَ إِنَّ كُنْتُ كَاذِبًا فَصَيِّرْكَ اللَّهُ إِلَى مَا كُنْتُ . قَالَ وَآتَى الْأَقْرَعَ فِي صُورَتِهِ فَقَالَ لَهُ مِثْلَ مَا قَالَ لِهَذَا وَرَدَّ عَلَيْهِ مِثْلَ مَا رَدَّ عَلَى هَذَا فَقَالَ إِنَّ

كُنْتُ كَاذِبًا فَصَيَّرَكَ اللَّهُ إِلَى مَا كُنْتُ . قَالَ وَأَتَى الْأَعْمَى فِي صُورَتِهِ وَهَيئَتِهِ فَقَالَ رَجُلٌ مُسْكِينٌ وَابْنٌ سَبِيلٍ انْقَطَعَتْ بِي الْجِبَالُ فِي سَفَرِي فَلَا بَلَاعَ لِي الْيَوْمَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ ثُمَّ بِكَ أَسْأَلُكَ بِالَّذِي رَدَّ عَلَيْكَ بَصْرَكَ شَاةً أَتَبَلَّغُ بِهَا فِي سَفَرِي فَقَالَ قَدْ كُنْتُ أَعْمَى فَرَدَّ اللَّهُ إِلَيَّ بَصْرِي فَخُذْ مَا شِئْتَ وَدَعْ مَا شِئْتَ فَوَاللَّهِ لَا أَجْهَدُكَ الْيَوْمَ شَيْئًا أَخَذْتَهُ لِلَّهِ فَقَالَ أُمِسْكَ مَالَكَ فَإِنَّمَا ابْتَلَيْتُمْ فَقَدْ رُضِيَ عَنْكَ وَسُخِطَ عَلَى صَاحِبَيْكَ .

Abu Huraira narrated that he heard Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying: There were three persons in Bani Isra'il, one suffering from leprosy, the other bald-headed and the third one blind. Allah decided to test them. So He sent an angel who came to the one who was suffering from leprosy and said: Which thing do you like most? He said: Beautiful colour and fine skin and removal of that which makes me detestable in the eye of people. He wiped him and his illness was no more and he was conferred upon beautiful colour and beautiful skin. He (the angel) again said: Which property do you like most? He said: Camels, or he said: The cow the narrator is, however, doubtful about it, but (out of the persons) suffering from leprosy or baldness one of them definitely said: The camel. And the other one said: Cow. And he (one who demanded camel) was bestowed upon a she-camel, in an advanced stage of pregnancy, and while giving it to him he said: May Allah bless you in this. Then he came to the bald-headed person and said: Which thing do you like most? He said: Beautiful hair and that (this baldness) may be removed from me because people hate me for it. He wiped his body and his illness was removed and he was bestowed beautiful hair, and the angel said: Which wealth do you like most? He said: The cow. And he was given a pregnant cow and while handing it over to him he (the angel) said: May Allah bless you in this. Then he came to the blind man and he said: Which thing do you like most? He said: Allah should restore my eyesight so that I should be able to see people with the help of that. He wiped his body and Allah restored to him his eyesight, and he (the angel) also said: Which wealth do you like most? He said: The flock of sheep. And he was given a pregnant goat that gave birth to young ones and it so happened that one valley abounded in camels and the other one in cows and the third one in sheep. He then came to the one who had suffered from leprosy in his (old) form and shape and he said: I am a poor person and my provision has run short in

my journey and there is none to take me to my destination except with the help of Allah and your favour. I beg of you in His name Who gave you fine colour and fine skin, and the camel in the shape of wealth (to confer upon me) a camel which should carry me in my journey. He said: I have many responsibilities to discharge. Thereupon he said: I feel as if I recognise you. Were you not suffering from leprosy whom people hated and you were poor and Allah conferred upon you (wealth)? He said: I have inherited this property from my forefathers. Thereupon he said: If you are a liar may Allah change you to that very position in which you had been. He then came to the one who was bald-headed in his (old) form and said to him the same what he had said to him (one suffering from leprosy) and he gave him the same reply as he had given him and he said: If you are a liar, may Allah turn you to your previous position in which you were. And then he came to the blind man in his (old) form and shape and he said: I am a destitute person and a wayfarer. My provision have ran short and today there is no way to reach the destination but with the help of Allah and then with your help and I beg of you in the (name) of One Who restored your eyesight and gave you the flock of sheep to give me a sheep by which I should be able to make my provisions for the journey. He said: I was blind and Allah restored to me my eyesight; you may take whatever you like and leave whatever you like. By Allah, I shall not stand in your way today for what you take in the name of God. Thereupon, he said: You keep with you what you have (in your possession). The fact is that you three were put to test and Allah is well pleased with you and He is annoyed with your companions.

Explanation

“Then he came to the leper in his previous form” The Angel came to a man with leprosy in his previous form as well as the bald man. This happened to remind them how they were before to test them.

On a side note, some people use this Hadith of the Angel coming in the form of a leper and a bald man to show the permissibility for acting. This view is incorrect the Angel wasn't acting. Allah only sent that Angel to them to remind them of how they were before to serve as an admonition.

“I am a poor man and a wayfarer. I have lost my provisions...” The Angel went the leper and the bald man and said, “I am a poor man and a wayfarer and I haven't enough

money to reach my home, so can you give me a riding animal to help.

This hadith educates us that Allah tests people in good times and in bad times. Allah said, *"We shall make a trial of you with evil and with good, and to Us you will be returned.."* [Al-Anbiya-35].

In other words Allah tests a person while he's doing good to see if he's thankful or if he'll deny Allah's favours. Also, Allah will test a person during difficult times with poverty to see if he's patient or will he react apprehensively.

Allah sent the Angel to the them and he asked the leper what he loved the most? He said: *"A beautiful colour and beautiful skin, and to be rid of that which makes me detestable in the people's eyes. He touched him, and that which repelled people was cured."* His skin became nice again.

Then he said: *"What kind of wealth is dearest to you?"* He said: *"Camels or cows, so he was given a bulging pregnant she-camel and he said: "May Allah bless it for you."* This camel was close to giving birth.

Then he went to the bald man and said: *"What thing is dearest to you ?"* He said, *'Beautiful hair and to be rid of that which makes me detestable in people's sight.'* The Angel touched him and his hair grew back by Allah's permission.

He then said: *'Which kind of wealth is dearest to you?'* He said: *'Cattle, so he was given a pregnant cow. He said May Allah bless it for you.'* Then the Angel went to the blind man and said: *'What thing is dearest to you?'* He said: *'For Allah to restore my sight, so that I may see the .' He touched him and Allah restored his sight. Then he said: 'What kind of wealth is dearest to you? ' He said: 'Sheep.'* So he was given pregnant sheep and the animals produced plenty of offspring." Allah answered the supplication of the Angel and two years passed and this wealth grew, with multiple camels, cattle and sheep. Then after this Allah tested them again.

"There is no one to help me reach my destination today except Allah, and then you. I am asking you by the One Who gave you this beautiful skin and wealth – for a camel to carry me on this journey.' He said: *' I have many duties.'* i.e If I give you one then my wealth will finish. The Angel then said: *"It is as if*

I know you. Were you not the leper whom people regarded as detestable, a poor man to whom Allah gave wealth ?' He said: 'No; I inherited this wealth from my great-forefathers.' This is denying the favours of Allah and giving his wealth its due right. He didn't acknowledge that Allah made him wealthy.

Then he came to the blind man in his previous form and said to him what he said to the leper and when the leper replied, In the first case the Angel supplicated to Allah to bless them then and in the second time he made Dua against them. "he said: 'if you are lying then may Allah return you as you were.'

Then he came to the blind man in his previous form and the blind man acknowledged the blessings of Allah. He said: I said: ' I was blind then Allah restored my sight. Take whatever you want, and leave whatever you want, for, by Allah, I will not expect you to pay back anything that you take in the Name of Allah. He said keep your wealth for you were being tested and Allah is pleased with you and angry with your two companions.' Allah said : "But few of My slaves are grateful." [Saba 13] and "Truly, Allah is full of Bounty to mankind, but most men thank not." [Al-Baqarah 243]

This shows that being grateful for the bounties of Allah includes acknowledging Him and being thankful in the Heart, praising Him with the tongue, and sharing the favours He's given you by sharing them with others; seeking Allah's pleasure. These are the pillars of gratitude.

Chapter 12



Being patient with few Possessions in this Life

سَعْدَ بْنَ أَبِي وَقَّاصٍ قَالَ وَاللَّهِ إِنِّي لَأَوَّلُ رَجُلٍ مِنَ الْعَرَبِ رَمَى بِسَهْمٍ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَلَقَدْ كُنَّا نَغْزُو مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مَا لَنَا طَعَامٌ نَأْكُلُهُ إِلَّا وَرَقُ الْخُبْلَةِ وَهَذَا السَّمُرُ حَتَّى إِنَّ أَحَدَنَا لَيَضَعُ كَمَا تَضَعُ الشَّاةُ ثُمَّ أَضَبَحَتْ بَنُو أَسَدٍ تُعَزِّرُنِي عَلَى الدِّينِ لَقَدْ خَبْتُ إِذَا وَضَلَ عَمَلِي .

Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqas is reported to have, said: By Allah, I am the first person amongst the Arabs to throw an arrow in the cause of Allah and we used to go with Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and there was no food for us to eat but only the leaves of hubla and samur trees (they are wild trees) and as a result one of us would excrete stool like a sheep. (How strange it is) that now the people of Banu Asad (the progeny of Zubair) instruct me in religion and try to impose punishment upon me (in regard to it). If it is so (that I am so ignorant of religion), then indeed, In which case, I must have been doomed and misguided..

Explanation

This Hadith highlights the difficult times the Companions (رضي الله عنهم) experienced during the 1st migration. It also shows how Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqas was among the earlier people to embrace Islam, and among those well-grounded in the Fiqh of legal rulings. Sa'd was patient during his difficult times and trials.

“One of us would excrete stool like a sheep...” The feces that came out of them was like a sheep since they didn't have much to eat.

Al-Mubarakfuri said: “And now Banu Asad...” referring Ibn Khuzaymah ibn Mudrakha ibn Ilyas ibn Mudar. He was among those who became Muslim later. After the Prophet's (ﷺ) death he went apostate following Tulayha ibn Khuwaylid Al-Asad, who claimed he was a prophet. While Abu Bakr was the Caliph Khalid ibn Al-Waleed killed

them. While Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqas was the ruler of Kufa Ibn Khuzaymah used to say Sa'd was praying incorrectly. This is why Sa'd said, "Are you teaching me about my religion." In other words, you are trying to criticize and blame me for offering the prayer short, saying, "I don't offer the prayer properly!"

He rejected Banu Asad's criticism of him in issues of the religion; as he preceded them in Islam, and was among the earlier companions of the Prophet (ﷺ). Moreover, he went through extreme difficulties. *"In which case, I must have been doomed and misguided."* If what they are saying is so then I have become doomed and misguided.^[6]

The meaning of those words is I have preceded them in Islam, companioned the Prophet (ﷺ), remained patient during hard times and learned the legal verdicts of Islam. Now all of a sudden a new tribe to Islam is going to teach me its verdicts?! If that is so then I am a disaster if I haven't learned Islam and Iman during this long period. This is a rejection from Sa'd of their behaviour.

Chapter 13



Three things follow the Deceased and One Remains

أَنَسُ بْنُ مَالِكٍ، يَقُولُ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " يَتَّبِعُ الْمَيِّتَ ثَلَاثَةٌ فَيَرْجِعُ اثْنَانِ وَيَبْقَى وَاحِدٌ يَتَّبِعُهُ أَهْلُهُ وَمَالُهُ وَعَمَلُهُ فَيَرْجِعُ أَهْلُهُ وَمَالُهُ وَيَبْقَى عَمَلُهُ "

Anas ibn. Malik reported Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying:

Three things follow the burial of a dead man. Two of them come back and one is left with him: the members of his family, his wealth and his deeds. The members of his family and wealth return back and his deeds alone remain with him.

Explanation:

This hadith refers to people's situations in most cases. A person dies and in most situations his family, his wealth, and his deeds follow him; however, there are times when a person will die in a place and he has no family there with him or any money, and in this instance, these two things do not follow him.

"Two of them come back and one is left with him ..."The meaning here is that the close relatives follow the deceased to his grave. After that, they bury him ,they leave, and go about their way. Likewise, his wealth follows him. Included in this is the burial machine or jug used to place water inside of his grave. Following this, his wealth returns and the only thing remaining with him are his deeds.

Chapter 14



Fear of Competing for this worldly life

عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عَمْرٍو بْنِ الْعَاصِ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ - صلى الله عليه وسلم - أَنَّهُ قَالَ « إِذَا فُتِحَتْ عَلَيْكُمْ فَارِسُ وَالرُّومُ أَيُّ قَوْمٍ أَنْتُمْ ». قَالَ عَبْدُ الرَّحْمَنِ بْنُ عَوْفٍ نَقُولُ كَمَا أَمَرَنَا اللَّهُ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صلى الله عليه وسلم - « أَوْ غَيْرَ ذَلِكَ تَتَنَافَسُونَ ثُمَّ تَتَحَاسَدُونَ ثُمَّ تَتَدَابَرُونَ ثُمَّ تَتَبَاغُضُونَ أَوْ نَحْوَ ذَلِكَ ثُمَّ تَنْطَلِقُونَ فِي مَسَاكِينِ الْمُهَاجِرِينَ فَتَجْعَلُونَ بَعْضُهُمْ عَلَى رِقَابِ بَعْضٍ

`Abdullah ibn. `Amr ibn. al-`As reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: How would you be, when you ,conquer Persia and

Rome ? `Abdur-Rahman ibn `Auf said: We would say as Allah has commanded us. Thus Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: Nothing

else besides it? You would (in fact) compete with one another, then you would feel jealous of one another, then forsake one another, and then you will bear enmity against one another, or something to the same effect. Then you will go to the poor emigrants and would make some them as leaders of the others.

Explanation

'We will say what Allah has commanded us...' meaning we will praise Him and thank Him for the bounties He's given us and ask Him to increase us in those favours.

'You will compete with one another, then feel jealous of one another, then forsake one another, and then bear enmity against one another...' competing is a race to acquire something and hatred when someone beats you. This is the first stage of jealousy. Jealousy is when you wish that something a person has is removed from him, which results in forsaking a person. As for enmity then that happens after forsaking a person. This order is the way things occur. Forsaking a person is lesser than showing enmity towards him. Sometimes a person can forsake somebody and turn away from him, yet still show love towards him. Therefore, enmity follows forsaking an individual.

Chapter 15



Ponder over the Less Fortunate.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " انْظُرُوا إِلَى مَنْ أَسْفَلَ مِنْكُمْ وَلَا تَنْظُرُوا إِلَى مَنْ هُوَ فَوْقَكُمْ فَهُوَ أَجْدَرُ أَنْ لَا تَزِدُّوا نِعْمَةَ اللَّهِ "

Abu Huraira reported Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying: Look at those who are at a lower level than you are and don't look at those who are at a higher level than you, for this would make the favours (conferred upon you by Allah) insignificant (in your eyes)

Explanation

This hadith shows that the intelligent person should look at those who are lower than he is in wealth and physical appearance. Therefore if a person is poor he looks at one who is poorer than he is, and if he is sick then he looks at the one who is sicker than he is and so forth. This way he will not reject the blessings that Allah has given him. Now as for the issues of obedience and pursuing the next life, then in those cases the Muslim in his right mind should look at those are above him. Those who have preceded him in doing good deeds, he looks at those who have given charity, he takes heed of those you have made Haji and Umrah every year; because this kind of competing is competition in good. Allah said: *"and for this let those strive who want to strive."* [Al-Mutaffifin:26]

Chapter 16



The people in the cave who supplicated to Allah with their good deeds

عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عُمَرَ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ - صلى الله عليه وسلم - أَنَّهُ قَالَ « بَيْنَمَا ثَلَاثَةٌ نَفَرٍ يَتَمَشُّونَ أَخَذَهُمُ الْمَطَرُ فَأَوُوا إِلَى غَارٍ فِي جَبَلٍ فَأَنْحَطَتْ عَلَى فَمِ غَارِهِمْ صَخْرَةٌ مِنَ الْجَبَلِ فَأَنْطَبَقَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ فَقَالَ بَعْضُهُمْ لِبَعْضٍ انْظُرُوا أَعْمَالًا عَمِلْتُمُوهَا صَالِحَةً لِلَّهِ فَادْعُوا اللَّهَ تَعَالَى بِهَا لَعَلَّ اللَّهَ يَفْرُجُهَا عَنْكُمْ . فَقَالَ أَحَدُهُمُ اللَّهُمَّ إِنَّهُ كَانَ لِي وَالِدَانِ شَيْخَانِ كَبِيرَانِ وَأَمْرَاتِي وَلِي صَبِيَّةٌ صَغَارٌ أَرْعَى عَلَيْهِمْ فَإِذَا أَرَحْتُ عَلَيْهِمْ حَلَبْتُ قَبَدَاتٍ بِوَالِدَيَّ فَسَقَيْتُهُمَا قَبْلَ بَنِي وَأَنَّهُ نَأَى بِي ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ الشَّجَرُ فَلَمْ أَتِ حَتَّى أُمْسِيَتْ فَوَجَدْتُهُمَا قَدْ نَامَا فَحَلَبْتُ كَمَا كُنْتُ أَحْلُبُ فَجِئْتُ بِالْجَلَابِ فَقُمْتُ عِنْدَ رُءُوسِهِمَا أَكْرَهُ أَنْ أَوْقِظَهُمَا مِنْ نَوْمِهِمَا وَأَكْرَهُ أَنْ أُسْقِيَ الصَّبِيَّةَ قَبْلَهُمَا وَالصَّبِيَّةُ يَتَضَاعُونَ عِنْدَ قَدَمَيَّ فَلَمْ يَزَلْ ذَلِكَ دَائِبِي وَدَائِبُهُمْ حَتَّى طَلَعَ الْفَجْرُ فَإِنْ كُنْتُ تَعْلَمُ أَنِّي فَعَلْتُ ذَلِكَ ابْتِغَاءً وَجْهَكَ فَافْرُجْ لَنَا مِنْهَا فُرْجَةً نَرَى مِنْهَا السَّمَاءَ . فَفَرَجَ اللَّهُ مِنْهَا فُرْجَةً فَرَأَوْا مِنْهَا السَّمَاءَ . وَقَالَ الْآخَرُ اللَّهُمَّ إِنَّهُ كَانَتْ لِي ابْنَةٌ عَمٌّ أَحَبَبْتُهَا كَأَشَدَّ مَا يُحِبُّ الرَّجَالُ النِّسَاءَ وَطَلَبْتُ إِلَيْهَا نَفْسَهَا فَأَبَتْ حَتَّى آتَيْتُهَا بِمِائَةِ دِينَارٍ فَتَعَبْتُ حَتَّى جَمَعْتُ مِائَةَ دِينَارٍ فَجِئْتُهَا بِهَا فَلَمَّا وَقَعْتُ بَيْنَ رِجْلَيْهَا قَالَتْ يَا عَبْدَ اللَّهِ اتَّقِ اللَّهَ وَلَا تَفْتَحِ الْخَاتَمَ إِلَّا بِحَقِّهِ . فَقُمْتُ عَنْهَا فَإِنْ كُنْتُ تَعْلَمُ أَنِّي فَعَلْتُ ذَلِكَ ابْتِغَاءً وَجْهَكَ فَافْرُجْ لَنَا مِنْهَا فُرْجَةً . فَفَرَجَ لَهُمْ . وَقَالَ الْآخَرُ اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي كُنْتُ اسْتَأْجَرْتُ أَجِيرًا بِفَرَقٍ أَرَزُّ فَلَمَّا قَضَى عَمَلَهُ قَالَ أَعْطِنِي حَقِّي . فَعَرَضْتُ عَلَيْهِ فَرَقَهُ فَرِغَ عَنْهُ فَلَمْ أَزَلْ أُرْزَعُهُ حَتَّى جَمَعْتُ مِنْهُ بَقْرًا وَرِعَاءَهَا فَجَاءَنِي فَقَالَ اتَّقِ اللَّهَ وَلَا تَظْلِمْنِي حَقِّي . قُلْتُ أَذْهَبُ إِلَى تِلْكَ الْبَقَرِ وَرِعَائِهَا فَخُذْهَا . فَقَالَ اتَّقِ اللَّهَ وَلَا تَسْتَهْزِئْ بِي . فَقُلْتُ إِنِّي لَا أَسْتَهْزِئُ بِكَ خُذْ ذَلِكَ الْبَقَرِ وَرِعَاءَهَا . فَأَخَذَهُ فَذَهَبَ بِهِ فَإِنْ كُنْتُ تَعْلَمُ أَنِّي فَعَلْتُ ذَلِكَ ابْتِغَاءً وَجْهَكَ فَافْرُجْ لَنَا مَا بَقِيَ . فَفَرَجَ اللَّهُ مَا بَقِيَ .

'Abdullah ibn 'Umar reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ)

said: Three people set out on a journey. They were overtaken by rain and they had to find protection in a mountain cave where at its mouth there fell a rock of that mountain and thus blocked them altogether. One of them said to the others: Look to your good deeds that you performed for the sake of Allah and then

supplicate Allah, the Exalted, that He might rescue you (from this trouble). One of them said: O Allah, I had my parents who were old and my wife and my small children also. I tended the flock and when I came back to them in the evening, I milked them (the sheep, goats, cows, etc.) and first served that milk to my parents. One day I was obliged to go out to a distant place in search of fodder and I could not come back before evening and found them (the parents) asleep. I milked the animals as I used to milk and brought milk to them and stood by their heads avoiding to disturb them from sleep and I did not deem it advisable to serve milk to my children before serving them. My children wept near my feet. I remained there in that very state and my parents too until it was morning. And (O Allah) If You Know that I did that seeking thereby Your Face, grant us riddance from this trouble. (The rock slipped a bit) that they could see the sky. The second one said: O Allah, I had a female cousin whom I loved more than the men love the women. I wanted to have sexual intercourse with her; she refused but on the condition of getting one hundred dinars. It was with very great difficulty that I could collect one hundred dinars and then paid them to her and when I was going to have a sexual intercourse with her, that she said: Servant of Allah, fear Allah and do not break the seal (of chastity) but by lawful means. I got up. O Allah, If You Know that I did that seeking thereby Your Face, then rid us from this trouble. The situation was somewhat eased for them. The third one said: Allah, I employed a workman for a measure of rice. After he had finished his work I gave him his dues (in the form of) a measure of rice, but he did not accept them. I used these rice as seeds, and that gave a bumper crop and I became rich enough to have cows and flocks (in my possession). He came to me and said: Fear Allah, and commit no cruelty upon me in regard to my dues. I said to him: Takeaway this flock of cows and sheep. He said: Fear Allah and do not make a fun of me. I said: I am not making a fun of you. You take the cows and the flocks. So he took them. O Allah, If You Know that I did that seeking thereby Your Face then ease the situation for us. And Allah relieved them from the rest of the trouble.

Explanation

This hadith shows that those three people used to supplicate to Allah pleading to Him through their good deeds. This proves that it is legislated to supplicate to Allah using

good deeds and although these people are from Bani Israel then our legislation agrees with theirs and there are other texts that affirm this. The kind of supplication they did to Allah was by using His Most beautiful of names. Allah (تعالى) has said, *"To Allah belongs the most beautiful of names so call on Him by them."* [Al-'Araf #180]

This is permissible to supplicate to Him by using His names.

This hadith proves the good deeds are a means to remove a difficulty from a person in this life. Similarly, Allah will remove a difficulty for him in the next life, and he will be rewarded with an enormous reward, enter into Paradise, and be safe from the fire and earn his Lord's happiness. This hadith also verifies that actions are not correct or beneficial except through sincerity. This is the reason they all said: *"If You Know that I did that seeking thereby Your Face..."*

The second person had a female cousin who he loved very much and one day he was between her legs and then she reminded him about Allah, and when she did that he awakened from his heedlessness, became scared of Allah, jumped up and then left her; although he wanted to have his way with her. As a result of this, she kept him safe. There was no one there except Allah to stop him. He was on top of her between her legs, and who can hold back in this case?

However, the fear of Allah and his remembrance of Him standing between His Hands stopped him. His heart became full of fear which led him to leave off illegal sexual acts; although he could have done it; and there was nothing there to stop him. This is a great means of supplicating to Allah with a good deed. This is similar to the narration when He (ﷺ) said: *The angels said: That servant of Yours intends to commit evil. though His Lord is more Vigilant than he is. Upon this, He (the Lord) said: Watch him; if he commits (evil), write it against his name, but if he refrains from doing it, write one good deed for him, for he desisted from doing it for My sake*^[7].

In other words, for Your Pleasure, I didn't do it. It wasn't that I was of unable to, or afraid of the people. After this, the rock moved a little bit, however they still weren't able to exit.

In another narration :*“I left the gold I had given her ...”*^[8]

There are different narrations about the amount he gave her. In one report it said: “She refused to let me have my way with her until I paid 100 dinars, so had collected that and gave it to her. Also in the other report, it mentioned he paid her, “120 dinars.” This can imply that she asked him for 100 dinars and he gave her the other 20 on his own accord and cancelled the transaction without entering her. This is what Ibn Hajr mentioned in Fathul Bari.^[9] She kept trying to go to him, but she asked him to give her some money, but then he wanted to be alone with her, just the two of them, at that time she rejected. Then after that, she gave in to him due to her dire need as mentioned in the hadith.

These three mentioned in this story display supplicating to Allah with good deeds. The 1st one supplicated by righteousness to his parents. The 2nd one supplicated by the fear of Allah that distanced him from committing fornication. The 3rd person by paying his worker his complete wages. Finally, Allah removed from them their difficulty.

The first person supplicated then the rock moved a little bit, but they were not able to get out of the cave. Then the second person supplicated causing the rock to move a little bit more; nevertheless, they still weren’t able to exit completely until when the third person supplicated. After that, the rock moved again and they all walked out of the cave and this was by the bounty of Allah.

Chapter 17



The Kinds of People Allah loves

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ الْعَبْدَ التَّقِيَّ الْغَنِيِّ الْخَفِيِّ "

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: Allah loves the servant who is God-conscious and is free from want and is hidden (from the view of people).

Explanation

God-conscious in this hadith refers to the person who is God-fearing. A God-fearing person is obedient to Allah, follows His commands, and stays away from His prohibitions while remaining sincere in his worship. Free from want means the one who is rich or self-sufficient. Hidden from the people means he doesn't like to be famous, nor does he desire it.

Imam An-Nawawi said self-reliant is one who is self-sufficient and this kind of independence is loved. The Prophet (ﷺ) said: "Richness is not the abundance of wealth, rather it is self-sufficiency"^[10] Qadi Al-Iyyad held the view being wealthy and hidden from people meant that he was busy with his own affairs and worship, while at the same time kept good family ties or shows kindness towards the less fortunate. Some people view remaining away from people is better than mixing with them. Other people say mixing with the societies is better except in times of trials.^[11] The best opinion is that mixing with the people during trying times is more superior.

Chapter 18



The Hardships of the Prophet (ﷺ)

عَنْ عَائِشَةَ قَالَتْ إِنَّ كُنَّا آلَ مُحَمَّدٍ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ لَنَمْكُثُ شَهْرًا مَا نَسْتَوْقِدُ بِنَارٍ إِنَّهُوَ إِلَّا التَّمْرُ وَالْمَاءُ .

'A'isha (رضي الله عنه) narrated: We the family of Muhammad (ﷺ) used to spend (the whole) month in which we (did not need to) kindle the fire as (we had nothing to cook); we had only dates and water (to fill our bellies).

Explanation

This narration explains how the Prophet (ﷺ) lived a life of hardships while at that the same time he is the best of creation. Sometimes a fire wasn't even kindled in his house for an entire month. He and his family used to live off of dates and water.

Chapter 19



The Hardships of the Companions

رَبَّنَا مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - وَكَانَ قُوتُ كُلِّ رَجُلٍ مِنَّا فِي كُلِّ يَوْمٍ تَمْرَةً فَكَانَ يَمَضُّهَا ثُمَّ يَصُرُّهَا فِي ثَوْبِهِ وَكُنَّا نَخْتَبِطُ بِقِسِيِّنَا وَنَأْكُلُ حَتَّى قَرَحَتْ أَشْدَاقُنَا فَأَقْسِمُ أَخِطَّهَا رَجُلٌ مِنَّا يَوْمًا فَاِنْطَلَقْنَا بِهِ نَنْعِشُهُ فَشَهِدْنَا أَنَّهُ لَمْ يُعْطَهَا فَأَعْطِيَهَا فَقَامَ فَأَخَذَهَا .

Jabir (رضي الله عنه) said: We travelled with the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) and the food for each man among us, every day, was one date, which we would suck then wrap it in his garment. We would also knock down leaves with bows and then eat until the corners of our mouths were covered with ulcers. One day a man was overlooked when the dates were distributed, and we set out carrying him and we bore witness that he had not been given his date, then he was given it, and he stood up and took it.

Explanation

“And the food for each man among us, every day, was one date,..” they had one date which they would suck on and drink water along with it. This shows the difficulty the companions (رضي الله عنهم) endured, despite that they remained patient and continued to strive in Allah’s cause spreading Islam, thus they were successful.

“we would suck then wrap it in his garment...” Perhaps they did this so that it would last with them longer.

Chapter 20



The Benefit Of Treating Widows and The Poor Kindly

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " السَّاعِي عَلَى الْأَرْمَلَةِ وَالْمِسْكِينَ كَالْمُجَاهِدِ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ - وَأَحْسَبُهُ قَالَ - وَكَالْقَائِمِ لَا يَفْطُرُ وَكَالصَّائِمِ لَا يَفْطُرُ "

Abu Huraira reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: One who makes efforts (for earnings to be spent) on a widow and the destitute is like a striver in the cause of Allah, and I think he also said: He is like one who constantly stands for prayer and observes fast without breaking it.

Explanation

This means that he works and earns money and then spends it on the widow and the poor person. He takes their affairs into care with great concern. The widow is the one who has no husband, or her husband has abandoned her. The destitute person is the one who has a greater need than the poor person.

This narration shows the virtue of striving to help the widow and the destitute person. By doing this he is like the one who strives in Jihad for Allah's Pleasure, and like the person who stands and fasts earning a reward.

Chapter 21



Supporting the Orphan

عن أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " كَافِلُ الْيَتِيمِ لَهُ أَوْ لِغَيْرِهِ أَنَا وَهُوَ كَهَاتَيْنِ فِي الْجَنَّةِ " . وَأَشَارَ مَالِكٌ بِالسَّبَّابَةِ وَالْوُسْطَى .

Abu Huraira reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: One who looks after the orphan whether he is his relative or not, then He and I will be together in Paradise like this, and Malik (explained it) with the gesture by drawing his index finger and middle finger close together.

Explanation

Looking after an orphan is to spend money on him by raising him, clothing him, and educating him in your house and so forth; however what we find today with the charity organizations calling for the sponsoring of orphans, then this action rewards people for their money; nevertheless, this is not sponsoring an orphan, because two things have to exist;

The first one is spending money on him.

The second one is educating them.

"Looking after the orphan whether he is his relative..." means one of his close relatives like his grandfather, his brother, or his cousin.

"or not..." these words apply to someone who is not related to him and in that action is a reward as well.

He and I will be together in Paradise like this. This means that the one doing this will be a neighbour with the Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) in Jannah and this is an abundant reward. "Malik (explained it) with the gesture by drawing his index finger and middle finger close together."

Chapter 22



The Virtue of Building Masjids

عُبَيْدُ اللَّهِ الْخَوْلَانِيُّ يَذْكُرُ أَنَّهُ سَمِعَ عُثْمَانَ بْنَ عَفَّانَ عِنْدَ قَوْلِ النَّاسِ فِيهِ
حِينَ بَنَى مَسْجِدَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ إِنَّكُمْ قَدْ أَكْثَرْتُمْ وَإِنِّي
سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ " مَنْ بَنَى مَسْجِدًا - قَالَ
بُكَيرٌ حَسِبْتُ أَنَّهُ قَالَ - يَبْتَغِي بِهِ وَجْهَ اللَّهِ بَنَى اللَّهُ لَهُ مِثْلَهُ فِي الْجَنَّةِ

Ubaidullah al-Khawlani reported that when Uthman ibn. 'Affan tried to rebuild the mosque of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) the people began to talk about this. Uthman said:

You discuss it very much whereas I have heard Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying: He who builds a mosque-- and the narrator Bukair said: I think he also said: (for) seeking the pleasure of Allah- Allah would build (a similar house for him in Paradise).

Explanation

This narration shows the advantage of building a masjid and in exchange, Allah will build him a place similar in paradise if he fulfils two conditions:

The first condition is that he has to believe in Allah and His messenger.

The second condition is that he has to do this seeking Allah's Pleasure.

If the builder of the masjid isn't a believing Muslim, or if he does it seeking recognition then he won't be rewarded in the next life, instead, he's rewarded in this life. This hadith also affirms that this reward is awarded to the one who builds the masjid, establishes it, renovates it, and even expands it. As per the one who puts air fresheners on the walls, or decorates it, then this action is not considered building the masjid. This is what was understood by Amir al-Mu'minin Uthman (رضي الله عنه) when he intended to renovate the Prophet's (ﷺ) masjid. The people disliked that, so they said to him, "Why not you just leave it the way it was during the lifetime of Abu Bakr and Umar (الله رضي

عنهما) He then replied, "Your numbers have increased and I heard the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) say: *Whoever builds a masjid*. Bukair said: "Based on this hadith!" Bukair intended by those words that he also wanted that reward. There are two types of ways to build a masjid;

- The physical sense and this is done by literally building the structure.
- The spiritual sense which is done by doing deeds inside it.

Chapter 23



The Prohibition on Showing Off

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " قَالَ اللَّهُ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى أَنَا أُغْنَى
الشُّرَكَاءَ عَنِ الشُّرْكِ مَنْ عَمِلَ عَمَلًا أَشْرَكَ فِيهِ مَعِيَ غَيْرِي تَرَكْتُهُ وَشُرْكَهُ " .

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said that Allah the Most High and Exalted said: I am the One, in the least need of a partner. If anyone does anything in which he associates anyone else with Me, I will reject him and his deed.

Explanation

This hadith shows a serious admonition about showing off. Included in this hadith is evidence that major shirk invalidates all of one's deeds and removes a person from Islam, which would result in him remaining in the hellfire forever.

As for minor shirk like showing off then it only invalidates the deed that is mixed with it; however his other actions remain acceptable, and he does not apostate, nor will he remain in the fire endlessly.

There is a difference of opinion about the action of minor shirk. The first

issue states that he will be on a scale for good and bad deeds and if his bad deeds outweigh his good ones, then he will be punished, and then he will be removed from hell. If his good deeds outweigh his bad deeds then his act of showing off will be removed.

The second position is that it is considered among the major sins therefore he remains under Allah's will. This is what is apparent from the verse,

"Allah doesn't forgive that partners be joined with Him but will forgive everything else for whomever He wills."[An-Nisa':48]

So this verse includes major shirk and minor Shirk. Major shirk causes a person to remain in hell forever and minor shirk does not.

Chapter 24



The result of broadcasting and Publicizing Good Deeds

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " مَنْ سَمَّعَ سَمَّعَ اللَّهُ بِهِ وَمَنْ رَأَى رَأَى اللَّهُ بِهِ " .

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said :If anyone wants to have his deeds widely publicized, Allah will publicize (his humiliation). And if anyone makes a hypocritical display (of his deeds) Allah will make a display of him .

Explanation

Openly publicizing one's actions includes speaking, reading the Quran, and giving admonitions. Making a hypocritical display includes actions like praying and giving charity. This Hadith shows the severity of showing off and wanting to be seen. Allah will humiliate that person on the Day of Judgment, so whoever wants to be seen then Allah will let him be seen on the Day of Judgment. Whoever wants to be publicly heard of then Allah make him publicly heard on the Day of Judgment ,because the reward is part of the action.

Chapter 25



Guarding the Tongue

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " إِنَّ الْعَبْدَ لَيَتَكَلَّمُ بِالْكَلِمَةِ
يَنْزِلُ بِهَا فِي النَّارِ أَبْعَدَ مَا بَيْنَ الْمَشْرِقِ وَالْمَغْرِبِ " .

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: The servant says a word by which he will be sent down to the Hell-Fire farther than the distance between the east and the west.

Explanation

This is because this speech may make Allah, His book, His messenger and even His religion a target of ridicule. Moreover, this word may lead to apostasy, backbiting, taking or words of flattery speech to someone in authority; such as an Emir or a minister. Furthermore, these words could harm his fellow Muslim brother.

The human-being must be on alert about the tongue; because its dangers are grave. In contrast, there is another narration when the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "Indeed the servant will say a word which earns Allah's pleasure and he pays no attention to it, and by that Allah will raise his status"^[12]

For example, he says the word of Tawheed from sincerity and honesty, or he says a word in defence of his brothers honour or similar things like this. This hadith explains the dangers of the tongue and that the human being should safeguard his tongue, except in speaking about things that are good, or permissible.

The Prophet (ﷺ) said: "Whoever believes in Allah and the last day, then let him speak good or remain silent."^[13]

This is a serious warning about saying words that are harmful while the person doesn't pay any attention to them.

Chapter 26



The Prohibition against Disclosing One's Sins

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " كُلُّ أُمَّتِي مُعَافَاةٌ إِلَّا الْمَجَاهِرِينَ
وَإِنَّ مِنَ الْإِجْهَارِ أَنْ يَعْمَلَ الْعَبْدُ بِاللَّيْلِ عَمَلًا ثُمَّ يُصْبِحُ قَدْ سَتَرَهُ رَبُّهُ فَيَقُولُ
يَا فُلَانُ قَدْ عَمِلْتُ الْبَارِحَةَ كَذَا وَكَذَا وَقَدْ بَاتَ يَسْتُرُهُ رَبُّهُ فَيَبْيِثُ يَسْتُرُهُ رَبُّهُ
وَيُصْبِحُ يَكْشِفُ سِتْرَ اللَّهِ عَنْهُ "

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: All the people of my Ummah would get pardoned for their sins except those who publicize them. And (it means) that a servant should do a deed during the night and tell the people in the morning that he has done so and so, whereas Allah has concealed it. And he does a deed during the day and when it is night he tells the people, whereas Allah has concealed it.

Explanation

This hadith means that the one who doesn't disclose his disobedience is pardoned, because he is shy and he doesn't publicly broadcast his sins; hence no one will follow him in those evils. As for the one who publicly broadcasts his sins then he isn't among the people who are forgiven. He is among those also are considered publicly disgraced and he should be swiftly punished according to those sins. The reason for this is because he has publicly broadcasted his sins and evils, and then naive people will follow him and spread the falsehood.

Chapter 27



The creation of the Angels, Jinn and Mankind

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " خُلِقَتِ الْمَلَائِكَةُ مِنْ نُورٍ وَخُلِقَ الْجَانُّ مِنْ مَارِجٍ مِنْ نَارٍ وَخُلِقَ آدَمُ مِمَّا وُصِفَ لَكُمْ " .

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: The Angels were born out of light and the Jinns were born out of the spark of fire and Adam was born as he has been defined (in the Qur'an) for you (i. e. he is fashioned out of clay).

Explanation

This means that Adam was created from clay and for that reason when Satan was ordered to prostrate to Adam with the angels he said I am better than him; You created me from fire and You created him from clay.

He believed that fire was better than clay; therefore how can someone prostrate to someone lesser in virtue. This is a dispute against the command of Allah resulting from a wicked analogy. The first person to come up with corrupt analogies was Satan.

Chapter 28



The Believer's Affair is All Good

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ (ﷺ) "عَجَبًا لِأَمْرِ الْمُؤْمِنِ إِنَّ أَمْرَهُ كُلَّهُ خَيْرٌ وَلَيْسَ ذَاكَ لِأَحَدٍ إِلَّا لِلْمُؤْمِنِ إِنْ أَصَابَتْهُ سَرَّاءٌ شَكَرَ فَكَانَ خَيْرًا لَهُ وَإِنْ أَصَابَتْهُ ضَرَاءٌ صَبَرَ فَكَانَ خَيْرًا لَهُ ."

Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) said: How wonderful is the affair of a believer for there is good in every affair of his. This is not the case with anyone else except for the believer. If something good happens to him he thanks (Allah), thus there is a good for him in it, and if something bad happens to him he bears it patiently, so there is a good for him in it.

Explanation

"If something good happens to him..." this means he is faced with blessings during the times of ease and comfort. "and that is good for him.". Then Allah would write a reward for him as being amongst those who were grateful. Every affair of the Muslim is good and this only applies to the believer, unlike the disbeliever because he has no portion in that as mentioned in the Hadith. The Prophet (ﷺ) said:

"When believing servant is afflicted with an illness then Allah cures him it becomes an expiation for his previous sins and serves as a warning for him on his future behavior. When the hypocrite becomes sick and is healed he is like a camel with his family and wealth that's released not knowing anything or where he's headed."^[14]

When a disbeliever does a good deed in this world he is compensated for it in this life. For example, he's given good health, money, and etc, but when he arrives in the hereafter he will not find any good deeds. We seek refuge in Allah from that.

Chapter 29



The Story Of The People Of The Ditch And The Magician, The Monk And The Boy

عَنْ صَهْبٍ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " كَانَ مَلِكٌ فِيمَنْ كَانَ قَبْلَكُمْ وَكَانَ لَهُ سَاحِرٌ فَلَمَّا كَبِرَ قَالَ لِلْمَلِكِ إِنِّي قَدْ كَبِرْتُ فَأَبْعَثْ إِلَيَّ غُلَامًا أَعْلَمُهُ السَّحَرَ . فَبَعَثَ إِلَيْهِ غُلَامًا يُعَلِّمُهُ فَكَانَ فِي طَرِيقِهِ إِذَا سَلَكَ رَاهِبٌ فَقَعَدَ إِلَيْهِ وَسَمِعَ كَلَامَهُ فَأَعْجَبَهُ فَكَانَ إِذَا أَتَى السَّاحِرَ مَرًّا بِالرَّاهِبِ وَقَعَدَ إِلَيْهِ فَإِذَا أَتَى السَّاحِرَ ضَرَبَهُ فَشَكَا ذَلِكَ إِلَى الرَّاهِبِ فَقَالَ إِذَا خَشِيتَ السَّاحِرَ فَقُلْ حَبَسَنِي أَهْلِي . وَإِذَا خَشِيتَ أَهْلَكَ فَقُلْ حَبَسَنِي السَّاحِرُ . فَبَيْنَمَا هُوَ كَذَلِكَ إِذْ أَتَى عَلَى دَابَّةٍ عَظِيمَةٍ قَدْ حَبَسَتِ النَّاسَ فَقَالَ الْيَوْمَ أَعْلَمُ السَّاحِرَ أَفْضَلَ أَمْ الرَّاهِبُ أَفْضَلَ فَأَخَذَ حَجَرًا فَقَالَ اللَّهُمَّ إِنْ كَانَ أَمْرُ الرَّاهِبِ أَحَبَّ إِلَيْكَ مِنْ أَمْرِ السَّاحِرِ فَاقْتُلْ هَذِهِ الدَّابَّةَ حَتَّى يَفْضِيَ النَّاسُ . فَرَمَاهَا فَفَقَتَلَهَا وَمَضَى النَّاسُ فَأَتَى الرَّاهِبَ فَأَخْبَرَهُ فَقَالَ لَهُ الرَّاهِبُ أَيْ بُنَى أَنْتَ الْيَوْمَ أَفْضَلُ مِنِّي . قَدْ بَلَغَ مِنْ أَمْرِكَ مَا أَرَى وَإِنَّكَ سَتُبْتَلَى فَإِنْ ابْتُلِيتَ فَلَا تَدُلَّ عَلَيَّ . وَكَانَ الْغُلَامُ يُبْرِئُ الْأَكْمَةَ وَالْأَبْرَصَ وَيُدَاوِي النَّاسَ مِنْ سَائِرِ الْأَدْوَاءِ فَسَمِعَ جَلِيسُ الْمَلِكِ كَانَ قَدْ عَمِيَ فَأَتَاهُ بِهِدَايَا كَثِيرَةٍ فَقَالَ مَا هَذَا هُنَا لَكَ أَجْمَعُ إِنْ أَنْتَ شَفَيْتَنِي فَقَالَ إِنِّي لَا أَشْفِي أَحَدًا إِنَّمَا يَشْفِي اللَّهُ فَإِنْ أَنْتَ آمَنْتَ بِاللَّهِ دَعَوْتُ اللَّهَ فَشَفَاكَ . فَأَمَّنَ بِاللَّهِ فَشَفَاهُ اللَّهُ فَأَتَى الْمَلِكَ فَجَلَسَ إِلَيْهِ كَمَا كَانَ يَجْلِسُ فَقَالَ لَهُ الْمَلِكُ مَنْ رَدَّ عَلَيْكَ بَصْرَكَ قَالَ رَبِّي . قَالَ وَلَكَ رَبٌّ غَيْرِي قَالَ رَبِّي وَرَبُّكَ اللَّهُ . فَأَخَذَهُ فَلَمْ يَزَلْ يُعَذِّبُهُ حَتَّى دَلَّ عَلَى الْغُلَامِ فَجِئَ بِالْغُلَامِ فَقَالَ لَهُ الْمَلِكُ أَيْ بُنَى قَدْ بَلَغَ مِنْ سِحْرِكَ مَا تُبْرِئُ الْأَكْمَةَ وَالْأَبْرَصَ وَتَفْعَلُ وَتَفْعَلُ . فَقَالَ إِنِّي لَا أَشْفِي أَحَدًا إِنَّمَا يَشْفِي اللَّهُ . فَأَخَذَهُ فَلَمْ يَزَلْ يُعَذِّبُهُ حَتَّى دَلَّ عَلَى الرَّاهِبِ فَجِئَ بِالرَّاهِبِ فَقِيلَ لَهُ ارْجِعْ عَنْ دِينِكَ . فَأَبَى فَدَعَا بِالْمُشَارِ فَوَضَعَ الْمُشَارَ فِي مَفْرِقِ رَأْسِهِ فَشَقَّه حَتَّى وَقَعَ شَقَّاهُ ثُمَّ جِئَ بِجَلِيسِ الْمَلِكِ فَقِيلَ لَهُ ارْجِعْ عَنْ دِينِكَ . فَأَبَى فَوَضَعَ الْمُشَارَ فِي مَفْرِقِ رَأْسِهِ فَشَقَّه بِهِ حَتَّى وَقَعَ شَقَّاهُ ثُمَّ جِئَ بِالْغُلَامِ فَقِيلَ لَهُ ارْجِعْ عَنْ دِينِكَ . فَأَبَى فَدَفَعَهُ إِلَى نَفَرٍ مِنْ أَصْحَابِهِ فَقَالَ انْهَبُوا بِهِ إِلَى جَبَلٍ كَذَا وَكَذَا فَاصْعَدُوا بِهِ الْجَبَلَ فَإِذَا بَلَغْتُمْ ذُرْوَتَهُ فَإِنْ رَجَعَ عَنْ دِينِهِ وَإِلَّا فَاطْرَحُوهُ فَذَهَبُوا بِهِ فَصَعَدُوا بِهِ الْجَبَلَ فَقَالَ اللَّهُمَّ اكْفِنِيهِمْ بِمَا شِئْتَ . فَرَجَفَ بِهِمُ الْجَبَلُ فَسَقَطُوا وَجَاءَ يَمْشِي إِلَى الْمَلِكِ فَقَالَ لَهُ الْمَلِكُ مَا فَعَلَ أَصْحَابُكَ قَالَ كَفَانِيهِمُ اللَّهُ . فَدَفَعَهُ إِلَى نَفَرٍ مِنْ

أَصْحَابِهِ فَقَالَ اذْهَبُوا بِهِ فَأَحْمِلُوهُ فِي قُرْقُورٍ فَتَوَسَّطُوا بِهِ الْبَحْرَ فَإِنْ رَجَعَ عَنْ دِينِهِ وَإِلَّا فَأَذِفُوهُ . فَذَهَبُوا بِهِ فَقَالَ اللَّهُمَّ اكْفِنِيهِمْ بِمَا شِئْتَ . فَأَنْكَفَأَتْ بِهِمُ السَّفِينَةُ فَعَرِفُوا وَجَاءَ يَمْشِي إِلَى الْمَلِكِ فَقَالَ لَهُ الْمَلِكُ مَا فَعَلَ أَصْحَابُكَ قَالَ كَفَانِيَهُمُ اللَّهُ . فَقَالَ لِلْمَلِكِ إِنَّكَ لَسْتَ بِقَاتِلِي حَتَّى تَفْعَلَ مَا أَمَرْتُ بِهِ . قَالَ وَمَا هُوَ قَالَ تَجْمَعُ النَّاسَ فِي صَعِيدٍ وَاحِدٍ وَتَضْلُبُنِي عَلَى جِذْعٍ ثُمَّ خُذْ سَهْمًا مِنْ كِنَانَتِي ثُمَّ صَعِ السَّهْمَ فِي كَبِدِ الْقَوْسِ ثُمَّ قُلْ بِاسْمِ اللَّهِ رَبِّ الْغُلَامِ . ثُمَّ ارْزُمْنِي فَإِنَّكَ إِذَا فَعَلْتَ ذَلِكَ قَتَلْتَنِي . فَجَمَعَ النَّاسُ فِي صَعِيدٍ وَاحِدٍ وَصَلَبَهُ عَلَى جِذْعٍ ثُمَّ أَخَذَ سَهْمًا مِنْ كِنَانَتِهِ ثُمَّ وَصَعَ السَّهْمَ فِي كَبِدِ الْقَوْسِ ثُمَّ قَالَ بِاسْمِ اللَّهِ رَبِّ الْغُلَامِ . ثُمَّ رَمَاهُ فَوَقَعَ السَّهْمُ فِي صُدْغِهِ فَوَضَعَ يَدَهُ فِي صُدْغِهِ فِي مَوْضِعِ السَّهْمِ فَمَاتَ فَقَالَ النَّاسُ آمَنَّا بِرَبِّ الْغُلَامِ آمَنَّا بِرَبِّ الْغُلَامِ آمَنَّا بِرَبِّ الْغُلَامِ . فَأَتَى الْمَلِكُ فَقِيلَ لَهُ أَرَأَيْتَ مَا كُنْتَ تَحْذَرُ قَدْ وَاللَّهِ نَزَلَ بِكَ حَذْرُكَ قَدْ آمَنَ النَّاسُ . فَأَمَرَ بِالْأُحْدُوذِ فِي أَفْوَاهِ السَّكَكِ فَخُذْتُ وَأُضْرِمَ النَّيْرَانَ وَقَالَ مَنْ لَمْ يَرْجِعْ عَنْ دِينِهِ فَأَحْمُوهُ فِيهَا . أَوْ قِيلَ لَهُ افْتَحِم . فَفَعَلُوا حَتَّى جَاءَتِ امْرَأَةٌ وَمَعَهَا صَبِيٌّ لَهَا فَتَقَاعَسَتْ أَنْ تَقَعَ فِيهَا فَقَالَ لَهَا الْغُلَامُ يَا أُمِّهِ اضْبِرِّي فَإِنَّكَ عَلَى الْحَقِّ " .

Suhaib reported that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) thus said:

There lived a king before you and he had a (court) magician. As he (the magician) grew old, he said to the king: I have grown old, send some young boy to me so that I should teach him magic. He (the king) sent to him a young man so that he should train him (in magic). And on his way (to the magician) he (the young man) found a monk sitting there. He (the young man) listened to his (the monk's) talk and was impressed by it. It became his habit that on his way to the magician he met the monk and set there and he came to the magician (late). He (the magician) beat him because of delay. He made a complaint of that to the monk and he said to him: When you feel afraid of the magician, say: Members of my family had delayed me. And when you feel afraid of your family you should say: The magician held me up. It so happened that there came a huge beast (of prey) and it blocked the way of the people, and he (the young boy) said: I will come to know today whether the magician is superior or the monk is superior. He picked up a stone and said: O Allah if the monk is more beloved to You than the magician, then kill his beast so that the people may move freely. He threw it and killed it and the people moved freely . He threw that stone towards it and killed it and the people began to move about (on the path freely). He (the young man) then came to that monk and Informed him and the monk said: Sonny, today you are superior to me. Your affair has come to a stage where I find that you would be soon put to a trial,

and in case you are put to a trial then don't tell anyone about me. That young man began to treat the blind and those suffering from leprosy and he, in fact, began to cure people from (all kinds) of illness. When a companion of the king who had gone blind heard about him, he came to him with numerous gifts and said: If you cure me all these things collected together here would be yours. He said: I myself do not cure anyone. It is Allah Who cures and if you affirm faith in Allah, I shall also supplicate Allah to cure you. He affirmed his faith in Allah and Allah cured him and he came to the king and sat by his side as he used to sit before. The king said to him: Who restored your eyesight? He said: My Lord. Thereupon he said: It means that your Lord is One besides me. He said: My Lord and your Lord is Allah, so he (the king) took hold of him and tormented him till he gave a clue of that boy. The young man was thus summoned and the king said to him: O boy, it has been conveyed to me that you have become so much proficient in your magic that you cure the blind and those suffering from leprosy and you do such and such things. Thereupon he said: I do not cure anyone; it is Allah Who cures, and he (the king) took hold of him and began to torment him. So he gave a clue of the monk. The monk was thus summoned and it was said to him: You should turn back from your religion. He, however, refused to do so. He (ordered) for a saw to be brought (and when it was done) he (the king) placed it in the middle of his head and tore it into parts till a part fell down. Then the courtier of the king was brought and it was said to him: Turn back from your religion. And he refused to do so, and the saw was placed in the middle of his head and it was torn till a part fell down. Then that young boy was brought and it was said to him: Turn back from your religion. He refused to do so and he was handed over to a group of his courtiers. And he said to them: Take him to such and such mountain; make him climb up that mountain and when you reach its top (ask him to renounce his faith) but if he refuses to do so, then throw him (down the mountain). So they took him and made him climb up the mountain and he said: O Allah, save me from them (in any way) You like and the mountain began to quake and they all fell down and that person came walking to the king. The king said to him: What has happened to your companions? He said: Allah has saved me from them. He again handed him to some of his courtiers and said: Take him and carry him in a small boat and when you reach the middle of the ocean (ask him to renounce) his religion, but if he does not renounce his religion throw him (into the water). So they took him and he said:

O Allah, save me from them and what they want to do. It was quite soon that the boat turned over and they were drowned and he came walking to the king, and the king said to him: What has happened to your companions? He said: Allah has saved me from them, and he said to the king: You cannot kill me until you do what I ask you to do. And he said: What is that? He said: You should gather people in a plain and hang me by the trunk (of a tree). Then take hold of an arrow from the quiver and say: In the name of Allah, the Lord of the young boy; then shoot an arrow and if you do that then you would be able to kill me. So he (the king) called the people in an open plain and tied him (the boy) to the trunk of a tree, then he took hold of an arrow from his quiver and then placed the arrow in the bow and then said: In the name of Allah, the Lord of the young boy; he then shot an arrow and it bit his temple. He (the boy) placed his hands upon the temple where the arrow had bit him and he died and the people said: We affirm our faith in the Lord of this young man, we affirm our faith in the Lord of this young man, we affirm our faith in the Lord of this young man. The courtiers came to the king and it was said to him: Do you see that Allah has actually done what you aimed at averting. They (the people) have affirmed their faith in the Lord. He (the king) commanded ditches to be dug at important points in the path. When these ditches were dug, and the fire was lit in them it was said (to the people): He who would not turn back from his (boy's) religion would be thrown in the fire or it would be said to them to jump in that. (The people courted death but did not renounce religion) till a woman came with her child and she felt hesitant in jumping into the fire and the child said to her: O mother, endure (this ordeal) for it is the Truth.

Explanation

“And when the boy was on the way to the magician he met a monk, and he sat down and listened to what he said, and he liked it...” This shows that had he not learned from him then he would have been destroyed and been like the rest of the disbelievers in his era.

“When he came to the magician he would beat him. He complained to the monk about that, who said: “If you are afraid of the magician, say: “My family delayed me” and if you are afraid of your family, then say, “The magician held me up.” These words show that it’s permissible to lie to save lives and to prevent a punishment.

"Today I will find out if the monk is better." He picked up a stone and said: "O Allah if the monk is more beloved to You than the magician, then kill this beast so that the people may move freely. He threw it and killed it and the people moved freely... This was the first thing to happen to and his status wasn't clear to him, and he hadn't tasted the sweetness of faith. When he saw this beast preventing people from passing he took a rock and supplicated, "O Allah if the monk is more beloved to You than the magician, then kill this beast so that the people can move freely..." therefore, he threw the rock, the beast died and then the people moved freely. possibly this animal was a snake. In the narration on At-Tirmidhi "The animal was a lion." [\[15\]](#)

"He came to the monk and told him, and the monk said to him: "Sonny today you are better than me and I think you have reached a stage..." This is the monk acknowledging the boy's virtue. "Sonny..." are words that elders address a young person with. He wasn't his son by way of family. He was his son by way of learning. The monk saw the miracle the young boy was given from Allah by killing that beast. This miracle will guide him to piety and remaining upright.

Then the monk said, "I think you will be tested. If you are tested then do not tell anyone about me." The monk was certain about this as it's part of Allah's wisdom to test the believer.

He says: "Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested. And We indeed tested those who were before them. And Allah will certainly make (it) known (the truth of) those who are true, and will certainly make (it) known (the falsehood of) those who are liars, (although Allah knows all that before putting them to test). "[Al-Ankubut 2-3]

The person adhering to his religion will be tested at first and if he's patient then he will be rewarded abundantly.

"The boy started to heal the blind and lepers and to cure the people of all sicknesses." This is a miracle in the miracles that are given to the righteous. The first miracle was that he killed an animal; the second one is that he cured the blind and those with leprosy. He asked Allah to cure them by his hands and they were cured.

This hadith proves the miracles happened to the righteous and there are many examples like this. For example what happened to Maryam and the miracles she was given. She used to get fruits from the winter in the summer and fruits from the summer during the winter. Another instance was when Khubaib (رضي الله عنه) was going to being killed and he was eating a bunch of grapes. The Prophet (ﷺ) said: "By Allah, I never saw a prisoner better than Khubaib. By Allah, one day I saw him eating of a bunch of grapes in his hand while he was chained in irons, and there was no fruit at that time in Mecca."^[16]

"A companion of the king who had gone blind heard of that, and brought him many gifts and said: "All of this is for you if you will heal me." He said: "I do not heal anyone, but rather it is Allah who heals." If you believe in Allah. I will pray to Allah to heal you." So he believed in Allah and Allah healed him." The blind person was a Kafir and he used to sit with the king, and when he heard a young boy was curing blind people and those with leprosy by Allah's Will he went to him with a lot of gifts. He said all of these gifts are for you if you cure me. The boy told him only Allah can heal and if you choose to believe in Him I will call on Him asking Him to cure you. The blind man believed in Allah, then the young boy called on Allah and the man was cured.

"The king said to him: "Who gave you back your sight?" He said: "My Lord". He said: "Do you have a lord other than me?" This proves that the king was a disbeliever and he used to claim divine Lordship similar to that of Fir'aun. I seek refuge in Allah.

"The monk was brought and it was said to him: "Denounce your faith." But he refused. The king called for a saw to and placed the saw in the middle of his head and cut him in two. Then the companion of the king was brought and it was said to him: Denounce your faith." However, he refused and then the saw was placed in the middle of his head and he was cut in two..." All of these people were patient with their religion. This proves that the was monk was among the real scholars who didn't change or alter his belief, instead, he remained firm on monotheism. The king's companion also remained firm in his belief with faith in the heart until he was executed.

“They took him there, and took him up the mountain, and he said: “O Allah save me from them whoever You will.” The mountain shook and they fell and the boy came walking back to the king. The king said to him: “What happened to your companions?” He said: “Allah saved me from them.” These are the miracles of righteous devout servants of Allah. Allah protected him from their evil and destroyed them.

“He handed him over to another group of his companions and said: “Take him out in a boat to the middle of the sea. Then if he recants his faith, let him go, otherwise throw him overboard.” Some say it was a small boat and others say it was a big boat. This was the 2nd miracle of the boy. He put his trust in Allah and was saved. The boy said: “O Allah save me from them whoever You will.” The boat turned over and the young boy was saved from their harm. He then went back to the king walking.

“You will not be able to kill me unless you do what I tell you to. He said: “What is it?” He said: “Gather the people on a plain, and crucify me on the trunk of a tree, then take an arrow from my quiver and place the arrow in a bow and say: “In the Name of Allah, the Lord of the boy.” Then shoot me. If you do that, you will kill me.” This includes the advice of the young boy for Allah, for his religion, and an invitation to Islam for His creation, because he wanted people to see that so that they can believe. The king did what the young boy told him to do.

“So he gathered the people in one plain and crucified him on the trunk of a tree. Then he took an arrow from his quiver. Placed it in the bow and said: “In the Name of Allah, the Lord of the boy, and he shot him. The arrow struck his temple and he put his hand on his temple, where the arrow had landed and died. The people knew at the time that the king could not kill him, except with the assistance of the Lord. This is what the young boy wanted to be seen. Consequently, they all said:” We believe in the Lord of the boy, We believe in the Lord of the boy, We believe in the Lord of the boy...”

“People went to the king and said to him: “Have you seen what you wanted to avert?” By Allah, that which you feared has happened to you: the people have believed in Allah. He then ordered that ditches be dug at the beginning of each road.” They went to the King and said to him this is what you were afraid would happen. The people have believed in Allah

and the boy tricked you. He said gather the people on one plain and say in the Name of the Lord of the boy you will be able to kill me and you did that and the people believed.

“And fires be lit and he said: Whoever doesn’t renounce his faith, throw him in it or it was said, “make him jump into it.” So the king ordered that the road be split and that a ditch be dug with a fire lit inside. Everyone who does not apostate from his religion will be thrown inside of it. This is a great trial and test for those people believed in the Lord of the boy.

They did that until there came a woman with her infant son. She hesitated from jumping into it, but the child said to her: “O my mother, be patient (jump in the fire)for you are following the truth.” A young infant boy spoke while in the cradle and said to his mom, “O my mother be patient for you are following the truth.” His was among the two boys that spoke in the cradle.

These are the people of the ditch. They are mentioned in the Quran. Allah said: “By the heaven, holding the big stars . And by the Promised Day (i.e. the Day of Resurrection);And by the witnessing day (i.e. Friday), and by the witnessed day [i.e. the day of ‘Arafat (Hajj) the ninth of Dhul-Hijjah];Cursed were the people of the ditch (the story of the Boy and the King).Fire supplied (abundantly) with fuel, When they sat by it (fire),. And they witnessed what they were doing against the believers (i.e. burning them). They had nothing against them, except that they believed in Allah, the All-Mighty, Worthy of all Praise! [Al-Burooj 1-8]

This hadith shows that in the legislation before ours it was not permissible to express a word of disbelief, even if one was forced to do so by being punished and threatened to be killed, or thrown in jail. The monk was killed by having his body split into two and he did not say a word of this disbelief. Likewise, the king’s companion was thrown in the fire and he did not say a word of disbelief. The prophet (ﷺ) said that in another hadith, “Among the nations before you a (believing) man would be put in a ditch that was dug for him, and a saw would be put over his head and he would be cut into two pieces; yet that (torture) would not make him give up his religion. His body would be combed with iron combs that would remove his flesh from the bones and nerves, yet that

would not make him abandon his religion. By Allah, this religion (i.e. Islam) will prevail till a traveler from Sana (in Yemen) to Hadrarmaut will fear none but Allah, or a wolf as regards his sheep, but you (people) are hasty.”^[17]

As for our legislation if a person is forced by being punished, threatened to be killed, tortured, or imprisoned then it is permissible for him to take the exceptional case with the condition that he still has complete faith in his heart.

Allah said: “Whoever disbelieved in Allah after his belief, except him who is forced thereto and whose heart is at rest with Faith but such as open their breasts to disbelief, on them is wrath from Allah, and theirs will be a great torment. That is because they loved and preferred the life of this world over that of the Hereafter. And Allah guides not the people who disbelieve.” [An-Nahl 106]

This shows the vastness of our legislation and all praises belong to Allah. There is nothing wrong for whoever is patient and bears the hardship similar to the way Imam Ahmed did during the trial of the Quran being created to do so. However, if a person says a word of this disbelief without being forced to his on his own will and sound mind aware of what he is saying, then this is disbelief. Similarly, whoever says a word of disbelief jokingly has disbelieved. If somebody utters a word of disbelief while being forced and has disbelief in his heart has disbelieved.

This young boy was after the time of Moses or after Jesus, but it is more and likely that this happened after the time of Jesus, because this young boy was given miracles similar to those of what Jesus was given. He was able to free the people of leprosy and restore their sight. Moreover, it's possible it happened after the time of Moses, because he was given miracles similar to those that were granted to Moses. Allah gave the boy something from the truth to counter the falsehood of magic. This resembles the signs Allah gave Moses being way more superior to the magic of his time. The magicians knew at the time that which they were following was false and Moses was on the truth.

^[1] Al-Bukhari # 304

^[2] Tirmidhi 2353

- [3] At-Tirmithi #2320/ Ibn Majah 4110 graded as being Sahih by Imam At-Tirmithi
- [4] At-Tirmithi2320/ibn Majah 4110
- [5] Ibn Majah 3110
- [6] Minhatul Muam' am vol4/394
- [7] Muslim# 129
- [8] Al-Bukhari # 2272
- [9] Fathul Bari Vol 6/509
- [10] Al-Bukhari 6466
- [11] Explanation of Sahih Muslim by An-Nawawi /vol 18, pg 100-101
- [12] Bukhari 6478
- [13] Bukhari 6018/Muslim 47
- [14] Al-Bayhaqi in Al-Iman (9446)
- [15] Jami' At-Tirmidhi #3340
- [16] Al-bukhari # 3045
- [17] Al-Bukhari #3612